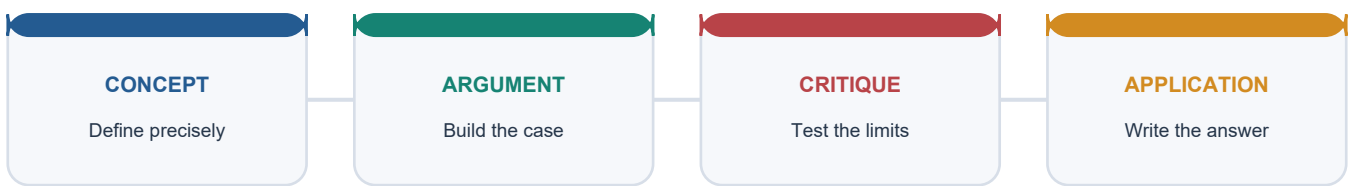


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Empiricism - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC Philosophy Optional | Paper I, Section A | 32 diagnostics, 12 solved PYQs and 6 original Mains models

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

Empiricism - Solved Practice Workbook	3
BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION	3
32 original MCQs - 24 core diagnostics and 8 remedial error-targeting drills	3
PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE	19
Practice status and source discipline - read once, applies to every solution below	19
ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS	31

Empiricism - Solved Practice Workbook

How to use this workbook. Attempt every item before reading its key. The correct option position was fixed independently for each question, so no rotation or predictable sequence can be exploited. Every option carries a question-specific explanation and every question carries a unique examiner trap. The solved previous-year questions reproduce the official printed wording exactly; the model answers are independent learner practice and are never official UPSC keys. **Terminology rule:** the English concept leads and the original Latin term follows immediately - *to be is to be perceived (esse est percipi)*, *blank slate (tabula rasa)*. Latin tags that are later labels rather than the author's own words are marked as such. **Contents:** 32 original MCQs - 24 core diagnostics and 8 remedial drills; 12 solved verified PYQs from 2018 to 2025; and 6 original solved Mains models, two each at 10, 15 and 20 marks.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

32 original MCQs - 24 core diagnostics and 8 remedial error-targeting drills

Answer placement: each correct option was fixed independently, so the key sequence is unpatterned rather than rotated. Options are matched for length, specificity, grammar and visible formatting so that the answer cannot be spotted by shape alone. Every question carries four question-specific option explanations and one unique examiner trap.

Coverage: the twenty-four core questions run across the whole printed clause - Theory of Knowledge; Substance and Qualities; Self and God; Scepticism - in Locke, Berkeley and Hume, together with innate ideas, sensation and reflection, the degrees of knowledge, abstraction and essence, the quality distinction, the substratum, personal identity, the demonstrative proof of God, nominalism, the five arguments for immaterialism, spirits and notions, the Hegel and Moore-Russell comparisons, impressions and ideas, the fork, the dissolution of substance, the belief in body and the analysis of causation. The eight remedial drills attack the specific confusions that cost marks every year.

MCQ 1. What the empiricist rule actually asserts

Consider the following statements about British empiricism as Locke, Berkeley and Hume hold it.

1. Every simple cognitive content must be traceable to experience, which includes inner awareness of the mind's own operations.
2. The mind's operations of comparing, combining and abstracting are themselves denied, since they are not derived from sensation.
3. No proposition whatever can be known independently of experience.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: statement 2 inverts the doctrine, because Locke's whole account of complex ideas depends on the understanding actively combining and comparing what sensation supplies.
- **B:** Incorrect: it retains the denial of mental operations and adds a blanket rejection of a priori knowledge that Hume's own class of relations of ideas immediately contradicts.
- **C:** Correct: the rule governs the **origin of simple content** and expressly includes reflection, while leaving both the mind's operations and Hume's relations of ideas untouched.
- **D:** Incorrect: accepting all three converts a thesis about where materials come from into a general hostility to reason that none of the three empiricists holds.

Examiner trap 1: Defining empiricism as hostility to reason is the commonest opening error in this item. Define it by the **origin of simple content**, and the answer stays on the printed syllabus from the first line.

MCQ 2. Locke's grounds for rejecting innate ideas

Which one of the following is **not** among the grounds Locke advances in Book I of the *Essay* against innate ideas?

- A. If certain ideas were innate, every human being including children would possess them, which they manifestly do not.
- B. A thought that the mind does not think is self-contradictory, since to be in the mind is to be perceived by the mind.
- C. Every idea alleged to be innate can be shown to arise instead through sensation or reflection.
- D. Innate ideas would have to be lodged in a material substratum whose nature is entirely unknown to us.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect as an answer, because the failure of universal assent is Locke's opening empirical ground against the innatist appeal to universal agreement.
- **B:** Incorrect as an answer, because the impossibility of an unperceived idea is Locke's second and philosophically decisive ground.
- **C:** Incorrect as an answer, because the availability of a genetic account is the redundancy argument that makes the innate hypothesis idle.
- **D:** Correct: the substratum belongs to Book II's account of substance and plays no part whatever in the anti-innatist argument of Book I.

Examiner trap 2: Candidates import the "something I know not what" from the discussion of substance into the discussion of innate ideas. Keep Book I and Book II separate, because the examiner's marking scheme does.

MCQ 3. Which ground does the decisive work

Locke's refutation of innate ideas is strongest against the dispositional innatism Descartes actually held only if one accepts his premise that

- A. to be in the mind is to be perceived by the mind, so an unnoticed idea is a contradiction
- B. children and the cognitively impaired demonstrably lack all of the alleged innate content
- C. the mind at birth is white paper, void of all characters, upon which experience writes
- D. every idea has in fact been traced back to some corresponding act of sensation or reflection

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: only this premise blocks the dispositional retreat, and it is a stipulation about the meaning of "idea" rather than an empirical finding.
- **B:** Incorrect: the empirical observation is compatible with innate ideas that are capacities awaiting an occasion, which is exactly Descartes' position.
- **C:** Incorrect: the blank-page image states Locke's conclusion about content and cannot function as the premise that establishes it.
- **D:** Incorrect: a completed genetic account would show innateness unnecessary, but the dispositional innatist can accept the genesis and still claim a native capacity.

Examiner trap 3: Scripts that give only the children-and-idiots argument have chosen Locke's weakest ground. Name the premise about what "in the mind" means, and then say honestly that it is a stipulation.

MCQ 4. Sorting Locke's complex ideas

Match each of Locke's three kinds of complex idea with its correct description.

1. Modes - 2. Substances - 3. Relations

I. Supposed independently existing bearers, represented through clusters of co-occurring qualities. II. Dependent combinations such as triangle, gratitude or number. III. Ideas produced by comparing one thing with another, such as cause or identity.

Which of the following is the correct matching?

A. 1-II, 2-I, 3-III

B. 1-I, 2-III, 3-II

C. 1-III, 2-II, 3-I

D. 1-II, 2-III, 3-I

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: modes are dependent combinations, substances are supposed bearers represented through quality-clusters, and relations arise from comparison.
- **B:** Incorrect: it makes modes into supposed bearers, which would leave Locke without any category for triangle, gratitude or number.
- **C:** Incorrect: it turns modes into comparative ideas and substances into dependent combinations, dissolving the distinction Locke needs for Book III.
- **D:** Incorrect: it keeps modes right but exchanges substances and relations, so that "gold" becomes a comparison and "cause" becomes a bearer.

Examiner trap 4: Listing the three kinds without noticing that **substance appears here as a complex idea** wastes the classification's real payload - the admission that we have a cluster plus a supposition, never an inspected substratum.

MCQ 5. The three degrees of knowledge

Match each degree of Lockean knowledge with the case it certifies.

1. Intuitive - 2. Demonstrative - 3. Sensitive

I. The existence of a particular thing now affecting the senses. II. The existence of God, established through intervening ideas. III. That white is not black, seen immediately without a middle term.

Which of the following is the correct matching?

A. 1-I, 2-III, 3-II

B. 1-III, 2-II, 3-I

C. 1-II, 2-I, 3-III

D. 1-III, 2-I, 3-II

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: it assigns immediate certainty to particular existents and relegates the self-evident case to the middle rank, inverting Locke's own ordering.
- **B:** Correct: intuition is immediate, demonstration proceeds through intervening ideas, and sensitive knowledge concerns particular things now present to sense.
- **C:** Incorrect: it makes God intuitively known, which Locke expressly denies, and demotes the existence of present things to demonstration.
- **D:** Incorrect: it starts correctly but then treats particular existents as demonstrated and God as sensed, which reverses the two lower degrees.

Examiner trap 5: The examinable point is not the list but the **placement of the external world at the weakest degree**. Say that, and the instability Berkeley exploits becomes visible in your own answer rather than in the examiner's comment.

MCQ 6. Locke's account of general words

According to *Essay* III.iii, an idea becomes general when the mind

- A. discovers a universal subsisting outside the mind and then forms an exact copy of it
- B. selects one particular idea and resolves to let it stand for all the others of that sort
- C. compares two particulars and perceives the relation that holds between them in reality
- D. separates it from the circumstances of time and place and from every concomitant idea

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: Locke expressly denies that general and universal belong to the real existence of things, calling them inventions and creatures of the understanding.
- **B:** Incorrect: making a determinate particular stand for a class is Berkeley's replacement doctrine at *Principles* Introduction Section 12, offered against Locke.
- **C:** Incorrect: comparison yields ideas of relation, which is a different category of complex idea and does not explain generality.
- **D:** Correct: abstraction is separation from circumstances of time, place and concomitants, leaving an idea that serves as a general representative of the sort.

Examiner trap 6: Attributing selective attention to Locke silently hands him Berkeley's solution and leaves the 2025 question with no dispute to explain. Keep **subtraction** with Locke and **selection** with Berkeley.

MCQ 7. Nominal and real essence

Consider the following statements about Locke's two essences.

1. The nominal essence of gold is the abstract idea annexed to the name, such as being yellow, heavy, malleable and soluble in aqua regia.
2. The real essence is the internal constitution from which the observable properties flow, and we generally do not know it.
3. Classification of things into sorts proceeds by real essence, which is why our species divisions track nature exactly.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 1 and 3 only
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: nominal essence is the known idea attached to the name and real essence is the unknown internal constitution, and only the first can do classificatory work.
- **B:** Incorrect: statement 3 contradicts Locke's central claim that sorting is the workmanship of the understanding rather than a reading-off of nature.
- **C:** Incorrect: it correctly describes real essence but then makes it the basis of classification, which would require the very knowledge Locke says we lack.
- **D:** Incorrect: accepting statement 3 alongside the other two makes Locke both agnostic about real essences and dependent on them for sorting.

Examiner trap 7: Writing that Locke "denies real essences" is as wrong as writing that we classify by them. He affirms that things have internal constitutions and denies that we know them.

MCQ 8. What Locke means by a secondary quality

For Locke, the sweetness of a lump of sugar is best described as

- A. an idea existing only in the mind, with nothing at all in the sugar corresponding to it
- B. a power in the sugar, grounded in its primary-quality configuration, to produce a sensation
- C. an illusion produced by the imagination when qualities are constantly conjoined in our experience
- D. a primary quality whose resemblance to our idea is guaranteed by the principle of divine veracity

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: it drops the crucial word "power" and leaves the object with no basis at all for the sensation, which is Berkeley's position rather than Locke's.
- **B:** Correct: secondary qualities are **powers** in the object, arising from primary-quality arrangements acting on our sense-organs.
- **C:** Incorrect: fictions produced by constant conjunction belong to Hume's account of substance and necessity, not to Locke's account of qualities.
- **D:** Incorrect: sweetness is precisely not a primary quality, and Locke denies that ideas of secondary qualities resemble anything in the object.

Examiner trap 8: "Secondary qualities are subjective" is the sentence that loses the mark. Write "**powers**", because the sugar really does have the power even though our idea resembles nothing in it.

MCQ 9. The substratum in Locke

Which one of the following most accurately states Locke's position on substance at *Essay II.xxiii.2*?

- A. Substance is a self-contradictory abstraction, since being and supporting cannot be combined into any single idea at all.
- B. Substance is directly perceived by the understanding whenever a cluster of qualities is presented together in experience.
- C. Substance is a fiction of the imagination, invented only because the qualities are found to be constantly conjoined.
- D. Substance exists and supports the qualities, but we have no positive idea of its nature and merely suppose a support.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the charge that substance-in-general is an incoherent abstraction is Berkeley's conclusion, drawn against Locke rather than stated by him.
- **B:** Incorrect: Locke's whole point is that the cluster is perceived while the supposed support is never presented to sense at all.
- **C:** Incorrect: the diagnosis of substance as an imaginative fiction produced by constant conjunction is Hume's verdict, reached by applying the copy principle.
- **D:** Correct: Locke affirms existence and denies knowledge of nature, describing the substratum as "a supposition of he knows not what support of such qualities".

Examiner trap 9: The three positions on substance are easy to swap under time pressure. Fix them by their verbs: Locke **supposes**, Berkeley **denies the sense**, Hume **dissolves into a bundle**.

MCQ 10. The prince and the cobbler

Locke's case in which the prince's consciousness comes to inform the cobbler's body is designed to establish that

- A. the identity of a person is fixed throughout by the continued existence of the same immaterial soul
- B. bodily continuity and consciousness must always coincide in any case that could actually occur
- C. memory is merely evidential, so that neither consciousness nor the body settles who the person is
- D. personal identity follows consciousness, while the identity of the human animal follows the organism

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the case is constructed precisely to detach personal identity from sameness of substance, immaterial or material.
- **B:** Incorrect: the thought-experiment is valuable because it prisms the two apart, and Locke's argument requires that they can in principle diverge.
- **C:** Incorrect: Locke does treat memory as the vehicle and evidence, but consciousness remains constitutive, so the person is definitely settled.
- **D:** Correct: the person who wakes is the prince and the man who wakes is the cobbler, which separates personal from animal and substantial identity in a single stroke.

Examiner trap 10: Retelling the story without stating the **three-fold distinction** it illustrates turns a decisive argument into an anecdote. Name person, man and substance before you narrate.

MCQ 11. Reid's Brave Officer

The Brave Officer case is directed against Locke's criterion because it shows that

- A. a criterion built on the reach of consciousness need not be transitive, whereas identity is
- B. memories of childhood are frequently unreliable and therefore cannot ground any criterion
- C. consciousness is interrupted every night by dreamless sleep, so no person survives until morning
- D. a person may be punished for an act that he sincerely and permanently fails to remember

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the officer remembers the boy and the general remembers the officer, but the general does not remember the boy, so the relation fails the transitivity that identity requires.
- **B:** Incorrect: the objection is formal rather than evidential, and it would succeed even if every remembered episode were perfectly accurate.
- **C:** Incorrect: the interruption problem is a distinct objection, answered by appeal to a continuing capacity for appropriation rather than to constant recollection.
- **D:** Incorrect: the forensic consequence is a difficulty Locke embraces, since he holds that we are accountable only for what we can appropriate.

Examiner trap 11: Stating the objection without the repair is only half the work. The Lockean answer is **overlapping chains** of consciousness, which restores transitivity at the cost of the simple memory reading.

MCQ 12. How Locke claims to know that God exists

In Locke's classification, the existence of God is known by

- A. intuition, since the idea of a most perfect being contains existence within itself
- B. sensitive knowledge, since the order of the perceived world is immediately given
- C. demonstration, proceeding from one's own existence by way of the causal principle
- D. an innate idea implanted in every mind and elicited on reaching the age of reason

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: an intuitive or definitional route is the ontological strategy, which Locke does not use and which sits ill with his account of ideas.
- **B:** Incorrect: sensitive knowledge is reserved for particular things now affecting the senses and could never reach an eternal being.
- **C:** Correct: from the intuitive certainty of my own existence, together with the principle that nothing comes from nothing, Locke demonstrates an eternal, most powerful and most knowing being.
- **D:** Incorrect: an innate idea of God is one of the candidates Book I explicitly dismisses, so this option contradicts the foundation of Locke's system.

Examiner trap 12: The examinable payoff is the **exposed premise**: the causal principle Locke leans on is exactly what Hume later refuses to certify. Name that link and the comparative question answers itself.

MCQ 13. What Berkeley's attack on abstraction does and does not deny

Consider the following statements about the Introduction to Berkeley's *Principles*.

1. He concedes that we can imagine a hand separately from the body, because such parts could exist apart.
2. He denies that we can frame an idea of extension without any colour or of motion without a determinate speed.
3. He concludes that general words and general reasoning are impossible and must be abandoned.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 3 only
- B. 1 and 2 only
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: statement 3 attributes to Berkeley the destruction of general reasoning, whereas he offers an alternative account of it in the very next section.
- **B:** Correct: he permits separation of what could exist apart, denies separation of what could not, and stops precisely there.
- **C:** Incorrect: it correctly reports the denial but adds a conclusion Berkeley never draws and which would make his own geometry unintelligible.
- **D:** Incorrect: accepting statement 3 turns a targeted attack on abstract ideas into a general scepticism about language that Berkeley expressly rejects.

Examiner trap 13: Berkeley denies **abstract** general ideas, not general ideas. A script that reports him as abolishing generality cannot then explain how the geometer proves anything.

MCQ 14. Berkeley's replacement account of generality

On Berkeley's positive account, an idea is general in virtue of

- A. being made to represent or stand for all other particular ideas of the same sort
- B. having every determinate feature stripped away until only the common nature remains
- C. corresponding to a nominal essence that the understanding annexes to a sortal name
- D. being formed by the imagination out of impressions that resemble one another closely

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: this is the formula of *Principles* Introduction Section 12, and the geometer's determinate inch-long line proving a theorem about all lines is its illustration.
- **B:** Incorrect: stripping determinations is precisely the Lockean abstraction Berkeley has just declared impossible.
- **C:** Incorrect: nominal essence is Locke's device, and Berkeley's objection is that no abstract idea is available to be annexed to the name.
- **D:** Incorrect: building general ideas out of resembling impressions describes a Humean associationist account rather than Berkeley's doctrine of representative use.

Examiner trap 14: The unpaid bill in Berkeley's account is what fixes the **respect** under which the particular idea represents. Raise it yourself and the answer reads as assessment rather than as reportage.

MCQ 15. Matching Berkeley's arguments for immaterialism

Match each argument with the move that characterises it.

1. Likeness - 2. Parity - 3. Master Argument - 4. Continuity

I. Every relativity consideration Locke accepts against secondary qualities applies to primary ones too. II. The involuntary and law-governed order of sense requires an active spirit of greater power than mine. III. An idea can be like nothing but an idea, so an unperceivable original cannot be resembled. IV. You cannot conceive a body existing unconceived, because in conceiving it you conceive it.

Which of the following is the correct matching?

- A. 1-III, 2-IV, 3-I, 4-II
- B. 1-III, 2-I, 3-IV, 4-II
- C. 1-I, 2-III, 3-II, 4-IV
- D. 1-IV, 2-I, 3-III, 4-II

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: it correctly identifies likeness but then exchanges parity and the Master Argument, so the relativity considerations are attributed to the wrong section.
- **B:** Correct: likeness is Section 8, parity is Section 9-15, the Master Argument is Section 22-23, and continuity is Section 6, 30-33 and 48.
- **C:** Incorrect: it treats parity as the likeness principle and continuity as the challenge about conceiving, reversing two independent arguments.
- **D:** Incorrect: it assigns the conceivability challenge to the likeness principle, which confuses a semantic point about resemblance with a psychological one about conceiving.

Examiner trap 15: Naming five arguments where the average script asserts one Latin tag is the largest single differentiator available on Berkeley. Learn them as **semantic, likeness, parity, master, continuity**.

MCQ 16. The likeness principle and its strongest answer

The most effective reply available to a defender of Locke against the principle that "an idea can be like nothing but an idea" is that

- A. structural or mathematical correspondence needs no qualitative likeness, as a map matches terrain
- B. divine veracity guarantees that our ideas of primary qualities resemble what causes them
- C. the principle is self-refuting, since Berkeley must compare his own ideas with one another in order to state it at all
- D. resemblance between an idea and a quality is a brute relation that stands in need of no further defence whatever

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: isomorphism preserves the representational relation while conceding Berkeley's point that a colour can only be like a colour.
- **B:** Incorrect: appealing to divine veracity answers the sceptical worry about reliability, not the semantic worry about what likeness could even mean here.
- **C:** Incorrect: Berkeley compares ideas with ideas throughout, which is exactly what his principle permits, so no self-refutation arises.
- **D:** Incorrect: declaring the relation brute concedes that it cannot be explained or checked, which is the objection rather than an answer to it.

Examiner trap 16: Treating the likeness principle as unanswerable produces an unbalanced answer. Concede that the **qualitative** thesis falls and defend the **structural** one; that is where the modern rescue of Locke lives.

MCQ 17. The Master Argument and the objection to it

The standard objection that Berkeley's Master Argument commits a scope or use-mention confusion holds that

- A. Berkeley illegitimately assumes that only spirits can be causes, which no materialist need ever concede
- B. the argument proves far too much, since it would equally show that unperceived numbers cannot exist
- C. what is inconceivable is conceiving of X that it is unconceived, not conceiving that X is unconceived
- D. conceiving a tree is a mental act, and mental acts are ideas, so the tree must itself be an idea too

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: voluntarism is the presupposition of the continuity argument, not of the challenge about conceiving an unconceived body.
- **B:** Incorrect: this is a different reductio, and Berkeley would in any case handle abstract objects through his account of representative use.
- **C:** Correct: the objection separates the content of the thought from the act of thinking, exactly as one can think about a number nobody has thought about.
- **D:** Incorrect: this restates Berkeley's own conclusion rather than objecting to it, and the inference from act to object is precisely what Moore later attacks.

Examiner trap 17: Building a Berkeley answer around the Master Argument alone is risky, because it is the weakest of the five and has a well-known reply. Use it fourth, and give Berkeley's question-begging rejoinder.

MCQ 18. Spirits, notions and the work God performs

Consider the following statements about Berkeley's positive ontology.

1. Spirits are known by notion rather than by idea, because an idea is passive and could never picture an activity.
2. The laws of nature describe stable sequences in a divine language, so regularities function as signs rather than as causes.
3. Berkeley infers God from the passivity of ideas together with the involuntary and orderly arrival of sense-experience.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 1, 2 and 3
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 1 and 3 only

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: it omits the derivation of God, which is the step that turns the ontology from a bare inventory into an argument.
- **B:** Correct: all three statements are accurate, and together they show that God is a structural requirement of immaterialism rather than a devotional addition.
- **C:** Incorrect: it drops the notion doctrine, without which Berkeley cannot claim to know spirits at all on his own principles.
- **D:** Incorrect: it omits the account of natural law, which is what allows Berkeley to answer the objection that immaterialism destroys science.

Examiner trap 18: Presenting God as an afterthought invites the reply that Berkeley is merely pious. Derive him from the **inertness of ideas** and the objection changes from piety to substitution of posits.

MCQ 19. Berkeley's idealism compared with Hegel's

The decisive difference between Berkeley's subjective idealism and Hegel's absolute idealism is that

- A. Berkeley denies the reality of the external world while Hegel affirms it as a moment of the Absolute
- B. Berkeley reaches idealism by dialectic while Hegel reaches it through an analysis of perception
- C. Berkeley treats matter as unknowable while Hegel treats it as fully knowable by natural science
- D. Berkeley's reality is ideas in finite and divine minds, Hegel's the self-development of Spirit

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: Berkeley does not deny the external world; he denies material substance and retains sensible things as collections of ideas.
- **B:** Incorrect: the methods are exactly reversed, since dialectical development is Hegel's procedure and anti-abstraction is Berkeley's.
- **C:** Incorrect: unknowable matter is Locke's substratum, which Berkeley rejects outright rather than adopts.
- **D:** Correct: one is a theistic subjective idealism resting on perception, the other an objective idealism in which objectivity is a moment within self-developing Spirit.

Examiner trap 19: Calling Berkeley "an early Hegel" is a category error the 2024 paper is designed to detect. The two differ **in kind**, not in degree, and the answer must say so explicitly.

MCQ 20. Moore and Russell against Berkeley

The difference between Moore's and Russell's reactions to Berkeley is best stated by saying that

- A. Moore accepts Berkeley's premises but rejects the conclusion, whereas Russell rejects them
- B. Moore defends the ordinary object as directly known, whereas Russell replaces it with a construction
- C. Moore relies on the verification principle of meaning, whereas Russell relies on the picture theory of meaning
- D. Moore denies the act-object distinction altogether, whereas Russell insists that awareness and object are identical

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: Moore's central move is to reject the premise that conflates the act of awareness with its object, so he does not accept Berkeley's premises.
- **B:** Correct: Moore's transparency argument supports direct realism, while Russell reconstructs physical objects analytically and keeps only structural objectivity.
- **C:** Incorrect: both doctrines named here belong to other syllabus items and to later phases, and neither is deployed against Berkeley in this context.
- **D:** Incorrect: it inverts both positions, since it is Moore who insists on the act-object distinction and the idealist who collapses it.

Examiner trap 20: The 2018 question asks a third thing after the two reactions: whether they **differ**. An answer that reports both and never contrasts them has left a whole limb unanswered.

MCQ 21. Impressions, ideas and the missing shade of blue

Consider the following statements about Hume's copy principle.

1. It holds that every simple idea derives from a corresponding simple impression.
2. Hume concedes the missing shade of blue as a case in which a simple idea arises without its antecedent impression.
3. The concession shows that the copy principle is an empirical generalisation rather than an analytic truth.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1, 2 and 3
- D. 1 and 3 only

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: it omits the consequence that makes the concession worth stating, namely the demotion of the principle to an empirical generalisation.
- **B:** Incorrect: it drops the statement of the principle itself, leaving the concession and its consequence without the claim they qualify.
- **C:** Correct: all three are accurate, and together they turn a descriptive report of Hume into a critical one.
- **D:** Incorrect: it asserts the consequence while omitting the very case that generates it, which leaves the criticism unsupported.

Examiner trap 21: Concede the missing shade **before** the examiner raises it, and supply Hume's reply that the shade is interpolated between impressions actually had, so the principle's spirit survives its letter.

MCQ 22. Placing two propositions inside Hume's fork

For Hume, the propositions "2+2=4" and "The Sun will rise tomorrow" differ because

- A. the first is certain and the second is highly probable, though both are ultimately relations of ideas
- B. the first is a matter of fact whose evidence is overwhelming, the second one whose evidence is weaker
- C. the first is a relation of ideas whose denial is contradictory, the second a contingent matter of fact
- D. both are matters of fact, differing only in the number of past instances that have so far supported them

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: it correctly notes the difference in certainty but then places both propositions in the same box, which erases the fork.
- **B:** Incorrect: treating an arithmetical truth as a well-evidenced matter of fact makes its denial merely improbable rather than contradictory.
- **C:** Correct: the fork divides a priori necessary relations of ideas from a posteriori contingent matters of fact, and conceivability is the operative test.
- **D:** Incorrect: counting instances is irrelevant to a relation of ideas, and this option reduces the distinction to a difference in inductive support.

Examiner trap 22: The 2018 question is built to catch exactly the answer that says both truths are equally necessary or merely differ in probability. Give the **conceivability** test in the first line.

MCQ 23. Substance and the belief in body

Consider the following statements about Hume.

1. He concludes that "substance" is a fiction of the imagination, since no impression of a bearer can be found.
2. The dissolution applies to material substance only, spiritual substance being secured by inner awareness.
3. Constancy and coherence among perceptions lead the imagination to feign continued and distinct bodies.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 2 and 3 only
- B. 1 and 2 only
- C. 1, 2 and 3
- D. 1 and 3 only

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: it retains the false exemption for spiritual substance and omits the general verdict that substance is an imaginative fiction.
- **B:** Incorrect: statement 2 is precisely the point at which Hume passes beyond Berkeley, who did retain spirit as an active substance.
- **C:** Incorrect: accepting statement 2 would make Hume's treatment of the self inconsistent with his treatment of body.
- **D:** Correct: the copy principle dissolves material and spiritual substance alike, while constancy and coherence explain why we nevertheless believe in continuing bodies.

Examiner trap 23: Writing that Hume "proves there is no external world" reverses his conclusion. He shows that **reason cannot justify** the belief, and then explains why nature makes it unavoidable.

MCQ 24. What Hume finds and does not find in causation

In Hume's analysis, the idea of necessary connexion is copied from

- A. the observed contiguity and temporal priority of the two events considered together in one instance
- B. an innate structure of the understanding that organises perceptions
- C. an impression of reflection: the mind's felt determination to pass from cause to effect
- D. the repeated observation that gives the hundredth collision a quality which the first collision lacked

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: contiguity and priority are genuinely observed, but they are precisely the elements that fall short of any necessity.
- **B:** Incorrect: an a priori rule of the understanding is Kant's answer in the Second Analogy, offered against Hume rather than by him.
- **C:** Correct: repetition changes the mind rather than the objects, and the felt determination it installs is the internal impression from which the idea is copied.
- **D:** Incorrect: Hume insists that repetition adds no new quality to the objects, so the hundredth collision is qualitatively identical to the first.

Examiner trap 24: Stopping at "constant conjunction" gives only the negative half. The positive half - the **impression of reflection** - is what makes the account an explanation rather than a denial.

MCQ 25 (remedial). The two definitions of cause

Hume's two definitions of cause are best characterised as

- A. one objective and regularity-based, the other psychological and framed by the thought conveyed
- B. one applying only to physical events and the other exclusively to acts of the human will
- C. two equivalent formulations that Hume explicitly proves to be interchangeable in every case
- D. an earlier definition given in the *Treatise* which he then formally withdraws in the *Enquiry*

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the first defines a cause as an object followed by another where all similar objects are so followed; the second as one whose appearance conveys the thought to the other.
- **B:** Incorrect: both definitions are perfectly general, and the discussion of volition is used to close an escape route rather than to found a second domain.
- **C:** Incorrect: the two pull apart rather than coincide, and Hume never demonstrates their equivalence - a tension that generates a modern debate.
- **D:** Incorrect: both definitions appear together in *Enquiry* VII, so there is no withdrawal of one in favour of the other.

Examiner trap 25: Giving only one definition is the most expensive omission in this sub-topic. Name **both**, then note that Hume leaves their relation unreconciled.

MCQ 26 (remedial). What the bundle theory denies

Hume's bundle theory of the self is correctly stated as the claim that

- A. the perceptions themselves are fictions, so that nothing whatever exists in the mind at all
- B. personal identity is constituted by the continuity of the living human organism over time
- C. the self is an active spirit whose existence is known by notion rather than by any idea
- D. there is no simple, identical self-substance, although the perceptions are entirely real

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: Hume never doubts the perceptions; his argument is precisely that they are all introspection delivers.
- **B:** Incorrect: an organism-based criterion is Locke's account of the same **man**, which he distinguishes carefully from the person.
- **C:** Incorrect: the active spirit known by notion is Berkeley's doctrine, and Hume's dissolution of spiritual substance is directed against it.
- **D:** Correct: what is denied is the owner behind the perceptions, and the perceptions in perpetual flux are what remain.

Examiner trap 26: "Hume says the self does not exist" is the sentence that wrecks this answer. Say that **no simple identical substance** is found, and then add the Appendix confession.

MCQ 27 (remedial). Kant's two routed replies

Match each Kantian doctrine with the Humean problem it answers.

1. Transcendental unity of apperception - 2. Second Analogy
- I. The absence of any source impression for necessary connexion between events. II. The absence of any constant and invariable impression of a continuing self.

Which of the following statements is correct?

- A. 1 answers I, and 2 answers II, since apperception concerns events and the Analogy concerns the subject
- B. Neither answers a Humean problem, since Kant rejects the copy principle
- C. Both answer II, since apperception and the Analogy are two names for the same doctrine of unity
- D. 1 answers II, and 2 answers I, and in both cases Kant accepts Hume's negative finding

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: it reverses the pairing, attaching the unity of the subject to the analysis of events and the causal rule to self-consciousness.
- **B:** Incorrect: Kant expressly agrees that no impression yields a soul-substance or a necessary connexion, and builds his reply on that agreement.
- **C:** Incorrect: they are distinct doctrines with distinct arguments, one concerning the unity of experience and the other the objectivity of succession.
- **D:** Correct: apperception addresses the missing unity of the self and the Second Analogy the missing necessity in causation, in each case by supplying a formal condition rather than an observed item.

Examiner trap 27: Reporting Kant as "proving the soul exists" or as "refuting Hume's premise" inverts him. He **accepts** the negative results and attacks the atomism of impressions instead.

MCQ 28 (remedial). Where every reply to the problem of induction must strike

Kant, Popper and Strawson all direct their answers to Hume's induction dilemma at the step which asserts that

- A. all reasoning about matters of fact beyond present sense and memory rests on cause and effect
- B. the Uniformity Principle can be established only demonstratively or probably, by no third route
- C. the denial of the Uniformity Principle implies no contradiction and is therefore perfectly conceivable
- D. any experiential argument for the Uniformity Principle already presupposes that very principle

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the dependence of factual inference on causal reasoning is accepted by all three respondents and is not the contested step.
- **B:** Correct: the exhaustiveness of the demonstrative-or-probable division is the fork applied reflexively, and each reply breaks it differently.
- **C:** Incorrect: the conceivability of nature changing is granted on all sides, and disputing it would require abandoning Hume's account of possibility.
- **D:** Incorrect: the circularity of experiential support is the least contested move in the argument and is generally conceded outright.

Examiner trap 28: An answer that attacks a horn of the dilemma without noticing that the **division itself** is Hume's fork has not located the argument's weight-bearing assumption.

MCQ 29 (remedial). Two sentences that must never be written

Consider the following two statements.

1. Berkeley denies the existence of the external world.
2. Hume denies causation.

Which of the following corrects both?

- A. Berkeley denies only unperceived objects, while Hume denies only that causes precede their effects
- B. Berkeley denies sensible things but keeps spirits; Hume denies causal inference but keeps conjunction
- C. Berkeley denies material substance but keeps sensible things; Hume denies objective necessity only
- D. Both statements are accurate summaries of the two positions and are safe to use in an examination

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: unperceived objects persist for Berkeley through divine perception, and temporal priority is one of the elements Hume explicitly retains.
- **B:** Incorrect: Berkeley affirms sensible things rather than denying them, and Hume never abandons causal inference, which custom makes unavoidable.
- **C:** Correct: each denial is narrower than the slogan, and stating the exact target is what converts a misreading into an accurate account.
- **D:** Incorrect: both are examiner-flagged misreadings, and either sentence can cost marks even when the rest of the answer is sound.

Examiner trap 29: These two slogans are the most frequently penalised sentences in the whole item. Replace them with the exact targets: **matter as unperceiving substratum**, and **observable objective necessity**.

MCQ 30 (remedial). Provenance and dating

Consider the following statements about the texts of this syllabus item.

1. "*Tabula rasa*" is Locke's own phrase in the *Essay*.
2. "*Esse est percipi aut percipere*" is Berkeley's own Latin in the *Principles*.
3. The chapter on personal identity was added to the *Essay* in the second edition of 1694.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. 3 only
- B. 1 and 2 only
- C. 1 and 3 only
- D. 2 and 3 only

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: only the dating claim is accurate, since Locke writes of "white paper, void of all characters" and Berkeley's own Latin at Section 3 is *esse est percipi* without the addition.
- **B:** Incorrect: both Latin attributions are later labels, one Scholastic in origin and the other a commentators' expansion made to accommodate spirits.
- **C:** Incorrect: it keeps the correct dating but repeats the *tabula rasa* misattribution, which is the commonest quotation error in this item.
- **D:** Incorrect: it keeps the correct dating but repeats the expanded Latin formula, which Berkeley never wrote.

Examiner trap 30: Free marks are available for a single provenance clause. Write "the doctrine traditionally labelled *tabula rasa*" and cite *esse est percipi* at Section 3 without the expansion.

MCQ 31 (remedial). What this syllabus item does not own

Which one of the following belongs to this syllabus item rather than to another owner?

- A. Quine's argument in "Two Dogmas of Empiricism" against the analytic-synthetic distinction
- B. Kant's transcendental exposition of space and time together with his table of the categories
- C. Hume's account of why we believe in continued bodies despite interrupted perception
- D. Hegel's dialectical method and the movement of determinate negation towards the Absolute

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the *Two Dogmas* material is routed to Quine and Strawson, and sharing the word "empiricism" creates no ownership here.
- **B:** Incorrect: Kant's positive system belongs to the next syllabus item and appears here only as the explicitly routed reply on the self and on causation.
- **C:** Correct: constancy, coherence and the feigned continuity of bodies are Hume's own doctrine and sit inside the printed clause on substance and scepticism.
- **D:** Incorrect: Hegel's method belongs to its own item and enters here only as one term of the comparison the 2024 paper requires.

Examiner trap 31: Importing another owner's doctrine wastes the words a 15-mark answer cannot spare. Kant, Hegel, Moore and Russell enter **only** where a routed question names them.

MCQ 32 (remedial). What a comparative answer in this item must contain

A twenty-mark comparative answer on Locke, Berkeley and Hume earns its marks primarily by

- A. narrating each philosopher's system in turn and closing with a paragraph of general observations
- B. announcing a single criterion, running matched axes, and ruling on the sequence it produces
- C. reproducing the chronology of publication so that the historical influences are fully displayed
- D. listing every objection raised against each thinker without adjudicating between them

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: three parallel summaries display information without explaining the relation the examiner has asked about.
- **B:** Correct: a stated criterion converts six separate disagreements into six consequences of one decision, which is exactly what a comparison is for.
- **C:** Incorrect: chronology prevents anachronism but does not by itself explain why each successor rejects his predecessor's exemption.
- **D:** Incorrect: an unadjudicated list of objections is journalism, and the residual column is where judgement is actually shown.

Examiner trap 32: The comparative mark is awarded for the **mechanism**, not for the coverage. State the criterion in the opening sentence and let the table function as evidence for it.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Practice status and source discipline - read once, applies to every solution below

Every model answer here is independent learner practice and is **never** an official UPSC key. Question wording is reproduced exactly as printed in the official papers; the 2019, 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024 and 2025 Paper I texts were read directly from the official question papers held in books\philosophy_optional\, and the 2018 and 2020 parts follow the repository's verified Western Philosophy PYQ ledger because those two Paper I question papers are not present locally. Doctrinal claims are attributed to their *Essay* Book.Chapter.Section, *Principles* section or *Treatise/Enquiry* location, and interpretive disputes - whether Locke's substratum is a humble posit or an empty placeholder, whether the Master Argument proves anything beyond a scope confusion, whether Hume is better read as a destructive sceptic or as a naturalist - are flagged as contested rather than settled.

Answer-length convention used throughout this package. UPSC Philosophy Paper I parts are written longer than General Studies answers. The working bands are **10 marks - about 150 to 200 words**, **15 marks - about 250 to 300 words**, and **20 marks - about 340 to 400 words**. Every solution below sits inside its declared band, and the demand decoding, the verdict heading and the "why this earns marks" notes are teaching apparatus that sit **outside** the timed word count.

Coverage: twelve directly owned Empiricism PYQs from 2018 to 2025 - every part the ledger routes to this syllabus item, in every year of the corpus - and six original solved Mains models, two each at 10, 15 and 20 marks.

Citation discipline used in every answer. Locke is cited by Book.Chapter.Section of the *Essay* (II.i.2, II.viii, II.xxiii.2, II.xxvii.9, III.iii.6-11, IV.vii.9); Berkeley by section of the *Principles* (Intro Section Section 6-25, and Section Section 3, 8, 9-15, 22-23, 27, 30-33); Hume by *Treatise* Book.Part.Section (I.i.1, I.iii.14, I.iv.2, I.iv.6, Appendix) and by *Enquiry* Section (II, IV, V, VII, X, XII). Latin tags that are later labels rather than the author's own words are marked as such.

2018 · Q1(a) · 10 marks

Question: Are the two truths-'The Sun will rise tomorrow' and ' $2+2=4$ ' of the same necessity for Hume? Give reasons in favour of your answer.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Are they ...? Give reasons" - a direct verdict in the first line, then justification
Core issue	Whether Hume's fork admits degrees of necessity or two different kinds
Scope boundary	Ten marks: the fork, the conceivability test, the induction consequence, one verdict
Ideal thesis	No - they belong to different classes, and the difference is in kind, not in degree of evidence
Non-negotiables	Relations of ideas versus matters of fact; denial-contradiction versus conceivability; custom; no appeal to "more probable"

Independent model answer

No. For Hume the two propositions fall on opposite sides of a division that admits no intermediate case.

" $2+2=4$ " states a **relation of ideas**. It is discoverable by thought alone, its truth does not depend on anything existing in the world, and its denial is self-contradictory. Necessity here is absolute and its warrant is *a priori*.

"The Sun will rise tomorrow" states a **matter of fact**. Its contrary - that the Sun will not rise - implies no contradiction whatever and is perfectly conceivable, which is Hume's operative test. No amount of past regularity converts conceivable falsehood into impossibility.

The reason is structural. Every factual inference beyond present sense and memory runs through cause and effect, and causal inference presupposes that the future will resemble the past. That principle cannot be demonstrated, since its denial is conceivable, and cannot be established from experience without circularity. What sustains the expectation is **custom or habit**, not reason.

So the necessity attaching to the sunrise is psychological - a felt determination of the mind - while the necessity of the arithmetical truth is logical.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Not of the same necessity: one is demonstrative, the other an unavoidable expectation grounded in habit.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - 2018 Q1(a): the question is a yes/no, and it must be answered before it is explained. A script that describes the fork without ruling has answered a different question.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 200 words: verdict in one line; each proposition placed in two or three lines; the induction consequence in four; the closing distinction in one.

- **Structure:** verdict -> classification of each proposition -> the reason the classification holds -> distinction of the two necessities.
- **Doctrine:** relations of ideas; matters of fact; the Uniformity Principle; custom.
- **Evidence:** conceivability of the contrary as the operative test; *Enquiry* IV and V.
- **Distinction:** logical necessity versus a psychological determination of the mind.
- **Criticism:** note that the fork is a classification, so the result is as secure as the fork itself.

2018 · Q3(a) · 20 marks

Question: How does Berkeley establish that Mind and its ideas alone are real? How do Moore and Russell react to Berkeley's view in this regard? Do you find any difference between Moore's reaction and Russell's one? Discuss.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Three limbs: establish, react, difference - all three must appear
Core issue	The derivation of immaterialism, and two distinct twentieth-century refusals of it
Scope boundary	Twenty marks: five arguments compressed, two reactions, one explicit contrast, one verdict
Ideal thesis	Berkeley's case is cumulative; Moore rejects the inference, Russell rebuilds the object - they differ in what they preserve
Non-negotiables	Anti-abstraction; <i>Principles</i> Section Section 1-4, 8, 9-15, 22-23, 30-33; act-object distinction; logical construction

Independent model answer

Berkeley's case is cumulative, and it begins before metaphysics. In the Introduction to the *Principles* he denies **abstract general ideas**: we may separate what could exist apart - a hand from a body - but not extension from colour, motion from determinate speed, or "man" from every determinate stature. Locke's *material substance in general* is exactly such an abstraction, compounded from the abstract idea of being and the relative notion of supporting, so "matter" is not an unknown thing but an expression without content.

Five arguments then follow. The **semantic** argument (Section Section 1-4) holds that the objects of knowledge are ideas, that "sensible things" means what is immediately perceived, and that an apple or a tree is nothing but a collection of such ideas; since ideas cannot exist unperceived, for sensible things *to be is to be perceived* (Section 3). The **likeness principle** (Section 8) holds that an idea can be like nothing but an idea, and that a resemblance to an unperceivable original could never be checked, which destroys Locke's representative relation. The **parity** argument (Section Section 9-15) extends Locke's own relativity considerations from secondary to primary qualities, leaving nothing for matter to be. The **Master Argument** (Section Section 22-23) challenges us to conceive an unconceived body and answers that in conceiving it we conceive it. Finally, since ideas are passive yet arrive involuntarily in settled order, an active infinite spirit must produce and sustain them (Section Section 30-33): reality is spirits and their ideas.

Moore attacks the inference from "experienced" to "dependent on experience" by distinguishing the **act** of awareness from its **object**: awareness of blue is not identical with blue. His transparency argument yields direct realism, on which the object is presented through, but not constituted by, consciousness.

Russell also refuses idealism, but instead of restoring the ordinary object he reconstructs it: physical objects are **logical constructions** from sense-data, perspectives and relations, so what is preserved is structure rather than the familiar thing.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Both refuse to reduce object to act, but they differ in what they save: Moore **defends** the ordinary object as directly known; Russell **replaces** it and retains only structural objectivity. Moore restores common sense; Russell restores science.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - 2018 Q3(a): the third limb is the discriminator. Many scripts report both reactions and never contrast them, forfeiting a third of the question.

Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 340 to 400 words: anti-abstraction in three lines; the five arguments in a compact paragraph each named; Moore in three lines; Russell in three; the contrast and verdict in three.

- **Structure:** ground clearing -> five named arguments -> two reactions -> explicit contrast.
- **Doctrine:** abstraction, *esse est percipi*, likeness, parity, master, continuity; act-object; logical construction.
- **Evidence:** *Principles* Intro Section Section 6-25 and Section Section 1-4, 8, 9-15, 22-23, 30-33.
- **Distinction:** defending the ordinary object versus replacing it with a construction.
- **Criticism:** note that the identification at Section 3 is a definition, which is why Moore's attack is on an inference and Russell's on an ontology.

2019 · Q4(b) · 15 marks

Question: Is there any element of necessity in causal relations according to Hume? Discuss.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Is there any element ...? Discuss" - a yes-and-no with a distinction , never a flat denial
Core issue	Where necessity is located once it is not found in the objects
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: the search, the internal find, both definitions, one qualification
Ideal thesis	Not in objects; yes in the mind, as an impression of reflection
Non-negotiables	Constant conjunction, priority, contiguity; the failed internal search; impression of reflection; two definitions

Independent model answer

Yes and no, and the distinction is the answer. In the **objects** there is no element of necessity; in the **mind** there is.

Hume applies the copy principle: if we have a genuine idea of necessary connexion, an impression must be produced. The external search fails. In a single instance of one billiard ball striking another, sense delivers only temporal **priority**, spatial **contiguity** and, across instances, **constant conjunction**. No impression of a power or tie is given, and repetition adds no new quality to the objects - the hundredth collision is qualitatively identical to the first.

The internal search fails as well. I have no impression of *how* the will moves a limb; the nerve and muscle are unknown to consciousness. This closes the Cartesian and occasionalist escape routes together.

What repetition does change is the observer. After constant conjunction the mind is **determined** to pass from the idea of the cause to that of the effect, and that felt determination is an **impression of reflection**. The idea of necessary connexion is copied from it, so necessity "is something that exists in the mind, not in objects".

Two definitions of cause follow: an object followed by another where all similar objects are so followed, and an object whose appearance conveys the thought to the other. The first is objective and regularity-based, the second psychological.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: There is a real element of necessity, but it is **subjective**: a fact about us, not about nature. Hume relocates necessity rather than abolishing it - and the two definitions he leaves unreconciled are the origin of the modern dispute between regularity and projectivist accounts.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - 2019 Q4(b): the word "any" makes a flat "no" wrong. Open with the distinction, then justify it.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words: the distinction in one line; the external search in five; the internal search in three; the impression of reflection in four; both definitions in three; verdict in two.

- **Structure:** distinction -> external search -> internal search -> the positive find -> both definitions -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** copy principle; constant conjunction; impression of reflection; custom.
- **Evidence:** the billiard balls; the volition case; *Treatise* I.iii.14 and *Enquiry* VII.
- **Distinction:** objective necessity denied, subjective necessity affirmed.
- **Criticism:** the two definitions pull apart and Hume never reconciles them.

2020 · Q2(a) · 20 marks

Question: "I never can catch myself at any time without perception, and never can observe anything but the perception." How does this statement by Hume problematize the philosophical notion of personal identity? How does Kant deal with this problem in his Critique of Pure Reason?

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Quotation-led, two limbs: how it problematises , then how Kant deals with it
Core issue	The absence of a constant impression of the self, and the formal condition Kant substitutes
Scope boundary	Twenty marks: the argument, the fiction of unity, the Appendix, then apperception with its limit
Ideal thesis	Hume dissolves the substantial self; Kant supplies a formal condition of unity, not a soul
Non-negotiables	Copy principle; bundle formula; resemblance and causation; Appendix retraction; "I think"; transcendental unity of apperception

Independent model answer

The sentence is the copy principle turned on the perceiver. If every legitimate idea traces to an impression, an idea of the self would require an impression constant and invariable through a whole life. Introspection delivers no such thing - only heat and cold, light and shade, love and hatred, pain and pleasure, succeeding one another in perpetual flux, and never the one who is finding them.

Hume's conclusion follows: the self is "nothing but a bundle or collection of different perceptions" (*Treatise* I.iv.6). The problem this creates is threefold. First, the **substantial** self is dissolved, so nothing owns the experiences and no bearer survives change. Second, **diachronic identity** loses its ground: the unity we feel is a fiction produced by **resemblance** and **causation**, which let the imagination pass smoothly along the series and mistake an easy transition for an identical object. Third, and most damagingly, the **Appendix** confesses that Hume cannot state the principle that unites the perceptions: "all my hopes vanish". Having denied both a substance and any real connexion between distinct existences, he has removed every resource such a principle could use - and the *Enquiry* silently drops the topic altogether.

Kant does not answer by restoring a soul. He **accepts** that no inner intuition reveals a simple substance, so the rational psychologist's argument is conceded to Hume. His move is transcendental: the "**I think**" must be able to accompany all my representations if they are to belong to one experience at all. The **transcendental unity of apperception** is therefore a formal condition of synthesising a manifold under rules - not a further item discoverable inside the bundle, and not an intuition of an enduring substance.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Kant answers the missing unity at the level of possible experience without proving an immortal self or a simple substance. The Humean may reply that a condition of description is not the discovery of a subject; Kant concedes the non-entity point and insists that rule-governed unity is presupposed by judgment. The exchange shows that the fault lay in the **atomism of impressions**, not in the self.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - 2020 Q2(a): the empiricist argument must be **complete** before Kant appears. A script that rushes to Kant loses the first limb.

Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 340 to 400 words: the derivation in five lines; the three problems in six; Kant in six; the verdict in four.

- **Structure:** derivation -> three problems -> the Appendix -> Kant's formal condition -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** copy principle; bundle; fiction of identity; apperception.
- **Evidence:** *Treatise* I.iv.6 and the Appendix; the "I think" formula.
- **Distinction:** a formal condition of experience versus an observed entity.
- **Criticism:** the failure indicts atomism; the *Enquiry* silently drops the topic.

2021 · Q1(c) · 10 marks

Question: "Sensible things are those only which are immediately perceived by sense." Explain Berkeley's theory of knowledge with reference to the above statement.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Explain ... with reference to the above statement" - the sentence must be used , not decorated
Core issue	The force of the word immediately and what it excludes
Scope boundary	Ten marks: the definition, the exclusion of inference, <i>esse est percipi</i> , one consequence
Ideal thesis	"Immediately" excludes Locke's mediated perception, and with it the veil and the matter behind it
Non-negotiables	Ideas as objects of knowledge; the collection thesis; Section 3; direct perception; no veil

Independent model answer

The sentence fixes a definition, and the whole theory follows from it. For Berkeley the objects of human knowledge are **ideas** - imprinted on the senses, perceived by attending to the mind's own operations, or formed by memory and imagination. A "sensible thing" is by definition what is **immediately** perceived by sense.

The word *immediately* is doing the work. Locke held that we perceive ideas which **represent** external objects, so that the object is reached mediately, by inference. Berkeley's definition removes the inference: if what is immediately perceived is an idea, and a sensible thing is what is immediately perceived, then an apple, a stone or a tree is nothing but a collection of such ideas.

Two consequences follow at once. First, the "veil of perception" disappears, and with it the sceptical problem it generated. Second, since ideas cannot exist unperceived, for sensible things *to be is to be perceived* (*Principles* Section 3), and "absolute existence without relation to their being perceived" is unintelligible.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Berkeley's theory of knowledge is direct realism about ideas: we know the world itself, not a representation of it - though the price is that the world is not material.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - 2021 Q1(c): the quoted line is a **definition of "sensible thing"**. An answer that never analyses "immediately" has not used the statement.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 200 words: the definition in three lines; the contrast with Locke in three; the two consequences in four; verdict in one.

- **Structure:** definition -> the force of "immediately" -> contrast with mediated perception -> consequences.
- **Doctrine:** ideas as objects of knowledge; the collection thesis; *esse est percipi*.
- **Evidence:** *Principles* Section 1-4 and Section 3.
- **Distinction:** immediate versus mediate perception.
- **Criticism:** note that the identification of thing with collection is a definition, which is where objections must strike.

2021 · Q1(d) · 10 marks

Question: Examine the concept of personal identity by Locke.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Examine" - state and test; a ruling on the objections is required
Core issue	Whether continuity of consciousness can constitute identity
Scope boundary	Ten marks: three identities, the criterion, one case, two objections, one verdict
Ideal thesis	Forensically indispensable, metaphysically incomplete
Non-negotiables	Person/man/substance; II.xxvii.9; appropriation; forensic; prince and cobbler; Butler-Reid; Brave Officer

Independent model answer

Locke separates three questions his predecessors ran together: sameness of **substance**, sameness of **man** (the continuing living organism), and sameness of **person**. Only the third is his subject.

A person is "a thinking intelligent being, that has reason and reflection, and can consider itself as itself, the same thinking thing, in different times and places" (*Essay* II.xxvii.9, added in the second edition of 1694). Identity of person therefore extends as far as present **consciousness** can **appropriate** a past thought or action as its own. Memory is the vehicle and evidence of that reach, not the definition. "Person" is, in Locke's own word, **forensic**: it is built for accountability.

The prince-and-cobbler case makes the separation vivid: transfer the prince's consciousness and the **person** who wakes is the prince while the **man** is the cobbler.

Two objections press hard. Butler and Reid charge **circularity**, since I can remember only my own experiences. Reid's **Brave Officer** shows the criterion is not transitive: the officer remembers the boy, the general remembers the officer, the general does not remember the boy.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Repaired as overlapping chains of consciousness, the theory survives Reid; the circularity charge remains open. Forensically indispensable, metaphysically incomplete.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - 2021 Q1(d): "Examine" is a two-part instruction. Doctrine alone, however accurate, caps the mark.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 200 words: three identities in two lines; definition and criterion in four; the case in two; objections in three; verdict in one.

- **Structure:** three identities -> definition -> criterion -> case -> objections -> graded verdict.
- **Doctrine:** consciousness, appropriation, forensic concept.
- **Evidence:** II.xxvii.9; the 1694 addition; prince and cobbler; the Brave Officer.
- **Distinction:** constitutive criterion versus evidential criterion.
- **Criticism:** the repair costs the simple memory reading.

2021 · Q1(e) · 10 marks

Question: "The relation between cause and effect is one of constant conjunction". Examine Hume's criticism of causation in the light of the above statement.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Examine ... in the light of the statement" - the quoted phrase must be tested, not merely repeated
Core issue	Whether constant conjunction exhausts the analysis
Scope boundary	Ten marks: the three observables, the missing power, the internal find, one qualification
Ideal thesis	Constant conjunction is necessary but not sufficient; the felt determination completes the account
Non-negotiables	Priority, contiguity, constant conjunction; no impression of power; impression of reflection; custom

Independent model answer

The quoted sentence is accurate but incomplete, and examining it is the answer.

Hume's analysis begins with what observation supplies: temporal **priority**, spatial **contiguity** and, across repeated instances, **constant conjunction**. What observation never supplies is a **power** or **tie** binding cause to effect. Applying the copy principle, Hume asks which impression the idea of necessary connexion is copied from. No external impression answers, and repetition adds nothing to the objects themselves.

The internal route also fails: I have no impression of how the will moves a limb.

What repetition does alter is the mind. After constant conjunction it is **determined** to pass from the idea of the cause to that of the effect, and this felt determination is an **impression of reflection** from which the idea of necessity is

copied. Causal necessity is therefore projected onto objects, not read off them, and the mechanism is **custom or habit**.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Constant conjunction alone is mere regularity; Hume's account requires priority, contiguity **and** the felt determination. He does not deny causation - he relocates its necessity from the world to the observer.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - 2021 Q1(e): the examiner supplies a partial formula. The mark is for showing what it omits.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 200 words: the three observables in three lines; the failed searches in four; the impression of reflection in three; verdict in two.

- **Structure:** what is observed -> what is not -> the internal search -> the positive find -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** copy principle; constant conjunction; impression of reflection; custom.
- **Evidence:** the billiard-ball case; *Treatise* I.iii.14; *Enquiry* VII.
- **Distinction:** regularity versus the full analysis including felt necessity.
- **Criticism:** "mere succession" is the misreading the quoted line invites.

2022 · Q4(c) · 15 marks

Question: Why and how does John Locke refute the innate ideas? Elucidate the nature and source of knowledge in Locke's epistemology.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Two limbs: why and how he refutes, then elucidate nature and source of knowledge
Core issue	The three grounds and the positive replacement they make room for
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: motive, three grounds, two fountains, simple/complex, degrees, one qualification
Ideal thesis	The refutation clears space for a genetic account; it defeats naive but not dispositional innatism
Non-negotiables	Universal assent; no unconscious ideas; redundancy; II.i.2; sensation and reflection; the three degrees

Independent model answer

Why. Locke's target is the claim that certain ideas and principles are stamped on the mind at birth. If true, it would license appeals to authority that no experience could check, and it would make an account of the *origin* of ideas unnecessary. Locke wants the origin of an idea to be the test of its legitimacy, so the innatist hypothesis must go first.

How. Three grounds, in Book I. First, **universal assent fails:** if such ideas were innate, all human beings including children would possess them, and they do not. Second, **there are no unconscious ideas:** a thought the mind does not think is self-contradictory, since to be in the mind is to be perceived by the mind. Third, a **genetic account is available:** every alleged innate idea, including God and non-contradiction, can be traced to experience, so the hypothesis is redundant.

The positive account. The mind is "white paper, void of all characters" (II.i.2) - the doctrine traditionally labelled *tabula rasa*, though the Latin is not Locke's. Experience has two channels: **sensation**, giving ideas of external objects, and **reflection**, giving ideas of the mind's own operations. **Simple** ideas are passively received; the understanding actively forms **complex** ideas as modes, substances and relations.

Knowledge is then the **perception of the agreement or disagreement of ideas**, in three degrees: **intuitive** (immediate), **demonstrative** (through intervening ideas) and **sensitive** (of particular existing things). Everything below is probability and judgement.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Locke defeats naive innatism decisively; against Descartes' **dispositional** innatism his empirical grounds miss, and everything rests on the premise about what "in the mind" means - a stipulation rather than a discovery.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - 2022 Q4(c): two limbs, two headings. The second limb is not an afterthought: "nature and source" means the definition of knowledge **and** its two fountains.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words: motive in three lines; three grounds in six; the positive account in six; the degrees in three; verdict in two.

- **Structure:** why -> three grounds -> sources -> nature and degrees -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** anti-innatism; sensation and reflection; simple and complex ideas; the three degrees.
- **Evidence:** *Essay* Book I; II.i.2; the classification at II.xii.
- **Distinction:** naive versus dispositional innatism.
- **Criticism:** the decisive ground is a stipulation about the meaning of "idea".

2023 · Q2(a) · 20 marks

Question: Critically analyse Hume's argument that causality is a matter of habit/custom involving psychological principle of association.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Critically analyse" - exposition plus a delivered verdict
Core issue	Whether reducing causal necessity to habit is an explanation or a capitulation
Scope boundary	Twenty marks: full analysis, both definitions, association, three objections, ruling
Ideal thesis	Hume succeeds against experience-based grounding of necessity; the result follows from his atomism
Non-negotiables	Three observables; failed internal search; impression of reflection; both definitions; practice versus justification

Independent model answer

Causation is the hinge on which empiricism's critique of metaphysics and science's rational basis both turn, so the argument deserves close statement before assessment.

The analysis. Observation of one event producing another delivers temporal **priority**, spatial **contiguity** and **constant conjunction**. It never delivers a power or tie. Applying the copy principle, Hume looks for the impression from which the idea of necessary connexion could be copied. The external search fails, and repetition adds no new quality to the objects. The internal search fails too: I have no impression of how volition moves a limb, which closes the Cartesian and occasionalist routes at once.

The positive account. Repetition changes the observer. After constant conjunction the mind is **determined** to pass from cause to effect; that determination is an **impression of reflection**, and the idea of necessity is copied from it. The mechanism is the **association** of ideas by resemblance, contiguity and causation, and the resulting expectation is **custom**, "the great guide of human life". Two definitions of cause follow - one objective and regularity-based, one psychological, conveying the thought to the other - and Hume never reconciles them.

Assessment. Three objections press. **Kant** replies that causality is an *a priori* rule required to distinguish objective succession from the subjective succession of perceptions, so necessity is contributed by the understanding rather than observed in objects. **Pragmatically**, the success of science suggests a real causal order - though Hume answers that success is a psychological fact about creatures built to expect, not a justification. **Self-referentially**, if inference is mere habit, Hume's own arguments lose their force; his defence is that he distinguishes the **practice** of inference, which nature compels, from its **justification**, which reason cannot supply.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Hume establishes that experience alone cannot ground causal necessity. But the result follows from the **atomism of impressions**: if perceptions are separable atoms, no relation can be perceived, and the conclusion is guaranteed by the premise. Kant's reply is therefore correctly aimed, since it attacks the atomism rather than the inference - while Hume's sceptical result stands as a permanent constraint on dogmatic metaphysics.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - 2023 Q2(a): "critically analyse" requires a ruling. Exposition alone, however complete, cannot reach the top band.

Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 340 to 400 words: frame in two lines; analysis in seven; positive account in six; three objections in six; verdict in four.

- **Structure:** frame -> analysis -> positive account -> three objections -> ruling.
- **Doctrine:** copy principle; association; custom; two definitions.
- **Evidence:** billiard balls and bread; *Treatise* I.iii.14; *Enquiry* IV, V, VII.
- **Distinction:** the practice of causal inference versus its justification.
- **Criticism:** the atomism of impressions guarantees the conclusion.

2024 · Q2(a) · 20 marks

Question: Is rejection of Locke's notion of primary qualities instrumental in Berkeley's leaning towards idealism? In this context, also discuss how subjective idealism is different from the absolute idealism proposed by Hegel.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Two limbs: an instrumentality verdict , then a comparison
Core issue	Which rejection actually does the work, and how two idealisms differ in kind
Scope boundary	Twenty marks: the quality distinction, parity and likeness, the abstraction ground, then matched axes for Hegel
Ideal thesis	Yes, but instrumentally through the likeness principle and anti-abstraction, not through relativity alone
Non-negotiables	Primary/secondary lists; Section Section 8, 9-15; abstraction as the deeper ground; Berkeley subjective and theistic; Hegel objective and dialectical

Independent model answer

Yes - but the answer must say **which** rejection is instrumental, since Berkeley uses two different weapons and only one of them is decisive.

Locke divides **primary** qualities - solidity, extension, figure, motion or rest, number - which are inseparable from body and whose ideas **resemble** them, from **secondary** qualities such as colour and warmth, which are **powers** to produce sensations and whose ideas resemble nothing.

Berkeley's first weapon is **parity** (*Principles* Section Section 9-15): every relativity consideration Locke accepts against secondary qualities applies to primary ones as well - apparent size varies with distance, motion with frame of reference, shape with angle of view. This is suggestive but not decisive, since a realist may reply that varying appearance is exactly what a mind-independent shape would produce.

The decisive weapon is the **likeness principle** (Section 8): "an idea can be like nothing but an idea", and a resemblance to an unperceivable original could never be checked. That removes the last property matter was supposed to have in its own right. Behind both lies the deeper ground: the attack on **abstract general ideas**, since Locke's *material substance in general* is the abstract idea of being plus the relative notion of supporting. Once abstraction fails, matter is meaningless rather than unknown, and only spirits and ideas remain.

Subjective versus absolute idealism. For Berkeley, reality is **ideas in finite and divine minds**; sensible existence *consists in* being perceived, and an infinite spirit causes and coordinates the ideas of sense while sustaining what finite minds do not perceive. For Hegel, reality is the **self-development of Absolute Spirit**, in which objectivity is a moment within a dialectical process driven by determinate negation; the Absolute is not an external perceiver preserving private idea-collections, and its method is developmental rather than perceptual.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: The rejection of primary qualities is instrumental, but as a *removal* rather than a *proof*: it clears matter away, while the positive idealism comes from the anti-abstraction argument and from the argument to an active infinite spirit. And Berkeley's theistic subjective idealism is not an early Hegelianism - the two differ in **kind**, not in degree.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - 2024 Q2(a): "instrumental" asks for a causal-explanatory ruling, not a narration of two doctrines.

Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 340 to 400 words: the distinction in three lines; parity in four; likeness and abstraction in six; the comparison in six; verdict in three.

- **Structure:** the distinction -> parity -> likeness -> abstraction -> matched-axis comparison -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** qualities; likeness; parity; abstraction; two idealisms.
- **Evidence:** *Essay II.viii*; *Principles* Section Section 8, 9-15 and Intro Section Section 6-25.
- **Distinction:** removal versus proof; subjective versus absolute idealism.
- **Criticism:** relativity alone does not entail mind-dependence.

2025 · Q2(c) · 15 marks

Question: Examine Hume's refutation of Causal relation and Kant's response to it.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Examine" both limbs - state each, then test whether Kant's answer succeeds
Core issue	Whether the Second Analogy answers Hume or presupposes what it must prove
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: Hume compressed but complete, Kant precise, one adjudication
Ideal thesis	Kant accepts Hume's negative result and attacks the atomism that produced it
Non-negotiables	No impression of necessary connexion; custom; both definitions; Second Analogy; synthetic a priori; things in themselves

Independent model answer

Hume. Observation of causal sequences delivers only temporal priority, spatial contiguity and constant conjunction; no impression of a power or tie is given, and repetition adds nothing to the objects. The internal route through volition fails equally. What repetition alters is the mind, which after constant conjunction is **determined** to pass from cause to effect - an **impression of reflection** from which the idea of necessity is copied. Hence two definitions of cause: regular succession of similars, and an object whose appearance conveys the thought to the other. The consequence is that inductive inference rests on **custom**, not reason.

Kant. He does not dispute the negative finding; he agrees that necessary connexion is not copied from a sensory impression. His answer is transcendental. In the **Second Analogy** the category of cause is an *a priori* rule required to distinguish an **objective** succession of events from the merely **subjective** succession of my perceptions. "Every event has a cause" is therefore **synthetic a priori** for possible experience: the understanding supplies necessary temporal ordering to phenomena, and objective empirical causation is rescued without any claim about causality among things in themselves.

Examination. The Humean challenge is that Kant has built the category into the definition of objective experience rather than proving it. Kant's reply is that without rule-governed synthesis, experience of an **event** would not be possible, so the presupposition is a condition of the fact to be explained.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Kant is correctly aimed: Hume's conclusion follows from the **atomism of impressions**, and it is that atomism, not the inference, which Kant attacks. Whether a condition of possible experience amounts to knowledge of nature remains contested - which is why the answer should close by grading, not by declaring a winner.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - 2025 Q2(c): the Hume limb must be complete before Kant begins; ownership discipline is itself a mark.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words: Hume in nine lines; Kant in seven; the examination in four; verdict in two.

- **Structure:** Hume -> Kant -> the challenge and reply -> graded verdict.
- **Doctrine:** copy principle; custom; two definitions; Second Analogy; synthetic a priori.
- **Evidence:** *Treatise* I.iii.14; *Enquiry* IV and VII; the ship-and-house contrast.
- **Distinction:** objective event-succession versus subjective succession of perceptions.
- **Criticism:** does Kant prove the category or presuppose it?

2025 · Q4(c) · 15 marks

Question: Explain Berkeley's doctrine of nominalism and his refutation of Abstract ideas.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Explain" - exhibit the derivation , not the conclusion
Core issue	The doctrine refuted, the refutation, the replacement, and the metaphysical payload
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: Locke's doctrine compressed, Berkeley's steps, the positive account, the consequence for matter
Ideal thesis	Nominalism is the foundation of immaterialism, not a corollary of it
Non-negotiables	III.iii and IV.vii.9; Intro Section Section 6-25; Section Section 12, 13, 19-20; matter as abstract general idea

Independent model answer

The doctrine refuted. For Locke everything that exists is particular, yet most words are general; words become general by signifying **general ideas**, and ideas become general by **abstraction** - separation from circumstances of time, place and every concomitant idea (*Essay* III.iii.6-9). The resulting "general representative" is the **nominal essence** annexed to a sortal name. Locke himself concedes that the general idea of a triangle must be "neither oblique nor rectangle, neither equilateral, equicrural, nor scalenon; but all and none of these at once", and that it is "something imperfect, that cannot exist" (IV.vii.9).

The refutation. Berkeley concedes that we may separate what **could** exist apart - a hand from a body, a torso from a head. He denies that we may separate what **cannot**: extension without colour, motion without determinate speed, "man" without stature. He then quotes Locke's own triangle sentence verbatim at *Principles*, Introduction Section 13, and concludes that no such idea can be framed. Therefore there are no abstract general ideas.

The replacement - nominalism proper. An idea is general not by being abstract but "by being made to represent or stand for all other particular ideas of the same sort" (Intro Section 12). A determinate particular idea, **selectively attended to**, does duty for a class: the geometer draws this black inch-long line and proves a theorem about all lines. Berkeley adds that words need not stand for ideas at all (Section Section 19-20).

The payload. Locke's *material substance in general* is precisely an abstract general idea - the abstract idea of being plus the relative notion of supporting. If abstraction is impossible, "matter" is not a mysterious unknown but a **meaningless expression**, so immaterialism rests on the nominalism.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Decisive against an **imagistic** Locke; against a **determinable** reading the objection misses, and Berkeley still owes an account of what fixes the respect of representation.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - 2025 Q4(c): the refutation cannot be explained without the doctrine refuted. Give Locke first, compressed but exact.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words: Locke in six lines; the refutation in five; the replacement in five; the payload in three; verdict in two.

- **Structure:** doctrine refuted -> refutation -> positive replacement -> metaphysical payload -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** abstraction; nominal essence; representative use; language beyond ideas.
- **Evidence:** IV.vii.9 quoted at *Principles* Intro Section 13; Section 12; Section Section 19-20.
- **Distinction:** separating what could exist apart versus what could not.
- **Criticism:** the determinable reading of Locke, and the unfixed respect of representation.

Six original questions in the UPSC idiom - two each at 10, 15 and 20 marks - with complete model solutions inside the same word bands. These are practice items, not predictions.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original 1 · 10 marks

Question: Is Locke's description of substance as "something, I know not what" an admission of ignorance or an abandonment of the concept? Examine.

Independent model answer

It is an admission of ignorance, and the distinction is exact.

Locke observes that we meet clusters of qualities that regularly go together - yellow, heavy, malleable, soluble in aqua regia - and cannot conceive them as subsisting on their own. We therefore **suppose** a support. But no impression of that support is ever presented, so we have "a supposition of he knows not what support of such qualities" (*Essay* II.xxiii.2).

Two things are denied and one is affirmed. Denied: any **positive idea** of the substratum, and any knowledge of the **real essence** it embodies. Affirmed: that something is qualified, since qualities do not float.

The concept is therefore retained as an **explanatory posit** tied to the stability of kinds, not abandoned. Berkeley's counter is that "support" here is a dead metaphor, and that removing it leaves the abstract idea of being conjoined with a relative notion - an abstract general idea.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Ignorance, not abandonment; but the posit's intelligibility depends on a doctrine of abstraction that Berkeley attacks, so Locke's humility is stable only while that doctrine holds.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the question offers a false dichotomy, and the mark is for refusing it precisely.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 200 words: the ruling in one line; the derivation in four; denied-and-affirmed in three; Berkeley in two; verdict in two.

- **Structure:** ruling -> derivation -> what is denied and affirmed -> the counter -> graded verdict.
- **Doctrine:** substratum; real essence; explanatory posit.
- **Evidence:** *Essay* II.xxiii.2.
- **Distinction:** no positive idea versus no existence.
- **Criticism:** the posit depends on abstraction.

Original 2 · 10 marks

Question: Berkeley holds that we have a "notion" of spirit though no idea of it. Is this distinction principled or merely convenient? Discuss.

Independent model answer

It is principled in its motive and vulnerable in its result.

The motive is internal to the system. Berkeley's ideas are **passive**; a spirit is **active**, perceiving and willing. An idea, being inert, could never picture an activity, so if activity is known at all it cannot be known by an idea. Hence spirits - my own, other finite minds, and God - are known by **notion** (*Principles* Section 27, 89, 140). Notions also cover relations, which likewise are not pictured.

The vulnerability is equally clear. Berkeley's case against matter was that an unperceivable substratum has no content. An unperceivable spirit, known by a faculty introduced for the purpose, invites the same complaint, and critics call the asymmetry ad hoc.

The strongest defence is that the asymmetry is **forced** rather than chosen: the objection assumes that all knowledge is idea-shaped, which is precisely what Berkeley denies once activity enters the ontology. Hume then tests the defence by refusing the exemption and dissolving spiritual substance as well.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Principled in derivation, unproven in adequacy - and Hume's refusal shows exactly how much weight it was carrying.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: "principled or convenient" demands a two-sided ruling, not a defence brief.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 200 words: motive in five lines; vulnerability in three; defence in three; verdict in one.

- **Structure:** motive -> vulnerability -> defence -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** passivity of ideas; activity of spirits; notions.
- **Evidence:** *Principles* Section 27, 89, 140.
- **Distinction:** forced asymmetry versus convenient exemption.
- **Criticism:** Hume removes the exemption and the self goes with it.

Original 3 · 15 marks

Question: "Berkeley destroys Locke's resemblance thesis but not his distinction between primary and secondary qualities." Critically examine.

Independent model answer

The statement is largely correct, and stating why requires separating two theses Locke runs together.

Thesis A - the explanatory distinction. Primary qualities are solidity, extension, figure, motion or rest and number: they are inseparable from body, since every fragment retains them, and they are the properties a corpuscular physics must attribute to any body. Secondary qualities are **powers**, grounded in primary-quality configurations, to produce sensations in us.

Thesis B - the resemblance claim. Our ideas of primary qualities **resemble** the qualities themselves; our ideas of secondary qualities resemble nothing in the object.

Berkeley attacks both. His **parity** argument (*Principles* Section 9-15) observes that the relativity considerations Locke accepts against secondary qualities apply equally to primary ones. But relativity does not entail mind-dependence: that a coin looks elliptical from an angle is exactly what a genuinely circular coin should produce. Thesis A therefore survives, though it must be restated as a distinction between **measurable-structural** and **response-dependent** properties rather than as a claim about what is "really in" the object.

The **likeness principle** (Section 8) is another matter. If an idea can be like nothing but an idea, and the alleged originals are unperceivable, then the resemblance could never be checked and the claim is empty. Thesis B falls. The available rescue is **isomorphism**: structural correspondence requires no qualitative likeness, as a map corresponds to terrain without being terrain-coloured - but this concedes Berkeley's point about likeness and defends something weaker.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Correct with one qualification: what survives is not Locke's distinction as he framed it, but its explanatory core. Locke's error was to make the division depend on a picture rather than on explanatory role - which is why physics retains the distinction while his version of it does not.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: a quotation-led "critically examine" requires you to grade the quotation, not merely to agree.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words: the two theses in seven lines; parity in five; likeness in five; verdict in four.

- **Structure:** separate the theses -> parity against A -> likeness against B -> graded verdict.
- **Doctrine:** quality lists; powers; resemblance; isomorphism.
- **Evidence:** *Essay* II.viii; *Principles* Section 8 and 9-15.
- **Distinction:** measurable-structural versus response-dependent properties.
- **Criticism:** the survivor is the explanatory core, not Locke's own formulation.

Original 4 · 15 marks

Question: Hume's Appendix confesses that he cannot explain what unites successive perceptions. Does this failure refute the bundle theory or diagnose a deeper problem? Discuss.

Independent model answer

It diagnoses a deeper problem, and reading it as a simple refutation misses what Hume has shown.

The doctrine. Applying the copy principle to the perceiver, Hume finds no constant and invariable impression of a self, only perceptions in perpetual flux, and concludes that the self is "nothing but a bundle or collection of different perceptions" (*Treatise* I.iv.6). The felt unity is a fiction produced by **resemblance** and **causation**, which let the imagination pass smoothly along the series and mistake an easy transition for an identical object.

The confession. In the Appendix Hume writes that all his hopes vanish when he comes to explain the principles that unite our successive perceptions. The admission is genuine, and the *Enquiry* silently drops the topic.

What it shows. Hume has denied two things at once: any **substance** in which perceptions inhere, and any **real connexion** between distinct existences. Together these remove every resource a uniting principle could have used. The failure is therefore not an accident of ingenuity but a consequence of the **atomism of impressions** - the doctrine that perceptions are separable atoms, so that no relation is given with its terms.

The comparison that clinches it. Exactly the same atomism generates the negative result about causation, where no relation between events can be perceived either. One premise, two failures.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: The bundle theory is not refuted by the confession; it is revealed as the last casualty of empiricist atomism. That Hume can find no principle of unity, and says so, indicts the premise rather than the self - which is precisely the diagnosis Kant makes when he supplies a formal condition of unity instead of an impression.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the question offers two readings; choose one and show why the other is superficial.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words: doctrine in six lines; confession in three; diagnosis in six; comparison in two; verdict in three.

- **Structure:** doctrine -> confession -> diagnosis -> parallel with causation -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** copy principle; bundle; fiction of identity; atomism.
- **Evidence:** *Treatise* I.iv.6 and the Appendix; the *Enquiry's* silence.
- **Distinction:** refutation of a theory versus diagnosis of a premise.
- **Criticism:** one premise produces both the missing self and the missing necessity.

Original 5 · 20 marks

Question: "The movement from Locke through Berkeley to Hume is a logical development rather than a historical accident." Critically analyse.

Independent model answer

The claim is defensible but needs one important correction: the movement is logical only because each successor supplies an **additional premise** his predecessor could have refused.

The shared rule. All three accept that every simple cognitive content originates in experience - Locke's sensation and reflection, Hume's impressions - while retaining the mind's operations of comparing, combining and abstracting.

Locke's exemption. He applies the rule to ideas but exempts **matter**, holding that ideas of primary qualities resemble their causes and that a substratum supports co-occurring qualities, though we have "a supposition of he knows not what support" (*Essay* II.xxiii.2). Sensitive knowledge of external things is his weakest degree, so the exemption is asserted at the point of least support.

Berkeley's step, and its premise. He removes the exemption with the **likeness principle**: an idea can be like nothing but an idea, and a resemblance to an unperceivable original could never be checked (*Principles* Section 8). Beneath this lies the attack on abstraction, since "material substance in general" is the abstract idea of being plus the relative notion of supporting. The **added premise** is comparability - that a resemblance no perceiver could verify is empty. A determined Lockean could resist by shifting to structural correspondence, which requires no qualitative likeness.

Hume's step, and its premise. He applies the same test to what Berkeley retained: spirit and causal power. No impression of a substantial self is found, so the self becomes a bundle (*Treatise* I.iv.6); no impression of necessary connexion is found, so necessity is relocated to an impression of reflection. The **added premise** is the **atomism of impressions** - perceptions are separable, so no relation is given with its terms. Berkeley could have resisted by denying that activity must be idea-shaped, which is exactly what his doctrine of notions asserts.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: The sequence is logical in structure and contingent in premises. Each stage is the previous position made consistent, which is why it is not a historical accident; but each stage also needs a premise that was available to be denied, which is why it is not a proof. That the rule consistently applied ends in a scepticism nobody can live is best read as a diagnosis of the rule's incompleteness - the conclusion Kant draws when he attacks the atomism rather than the inference.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: a "logical development" claim is won by exhibiting the **mechanism** and lost by narrating three systems.

Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 340 to 400 words: shared rule in three lines; Locke in five; Berkeley in six; Hume in six; verdict in five.

- **Structure:** shared rule -> exemption -> two removals with their added premises -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** resemblance; likeness; abstraction; bundle; necessary connexion.
- **Evidence:** II.xxiii.2; *Principles* Section 8 and Intro Section Section 6-25; *Treatise* I.iv.6 and I.iii.14.
- **Distinction:** logical structure versus contingent premises.
- **Criticism:** each added premise was resistible, so the slide explains without proving.

Original 6 · 20 marks

Question: Compare the role assigned to God by Locke, Berkeley and Hume, and assess what each system loses if the divine premise is withdrawn.

Independent model answer

The comparison is best run on one axis: **what job does God perform in the system?** Answered that way, three very different dependencies appear.

Locke - God as guarantor and conclusion. God's existence is known by **demonstration**, not intuition and not sensitive knowledge: from the intuitive certainty of my own existence, together with the principle that nothing comes from nothing, Locke infers an eternal, most powerful and most knowing being. God also does defensive work: divine non-deception supports the reliability of sense and the trustworthiness of our faculties for "the conveniences of life".

If withdrawn: the demonstration is lost, and the defence of representative realism weakens - but the epistemology survives, since the three degrees of knowledge and the two fountains of ideas stand independently.

Berkeley - God as cause and continuity. Ideas are passive; the ideas of sense arrive involuntarily in settled order; only spirits are active; therefore an infinite spirit produces them (*Principles* Section Section 30-33). God also secures the persistence of sensible things unperceived by finite minds, and the laws of nature become the settled grammar of a divine language, so regularities are **signs** rather than causes.

If withdrawn: the system collapses. Without an active infinite spirit there is no cause of the involuntary order, no continuity for unperceived objects, and no distinction between the real and the imaginary beyond the felt vivacity of one's own ideas. God is load-bearing here in a way he is not for Locke.

Hume - God as casualty. Every proof fails. The causal argument is cut at its premise, since there is no impression of necessary connexion licensing an inference to a transcendent cause. The design argument rests on a weak analogy, and even if granted proves at most a **finite** architect working on given matter; natural principles might explain order without intelligence; and the problem of evil blocks the inference to a perfectly good designer. Testimony can never make a miracle more probable than its own falsehood.

If withdrawn: nothing is lost, because nothing was resting on it.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: The dependency is inversely related to the empiricism's consistency. Locke uses God as a support, Berkeley requires him as a mechanism, Hume dispenses with him as unsupported. The comparison also exposes the deepest criticism of immaterialism: God performs exactly the two functions Locke assigned to matter - causing our ideas and sustaining the unperceived - so Berkeley's economy is a substitution of posits rather than an elimination of them.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: announce the axis - the **job God performs** - in the first line, and the comparison writes itself.

Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 340 to 400 words: axis in one line; each thinker in a paragraph with an explicit withdrawal test; verdict in four.

- **Structure:** axis -> three systems each with a counterfactual test -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** demonstrative proof; divine non-deception; passivity and continuity; the three failed proofs.
- **Evidence:** *Essay IV*; *Principles* Section Section 30-33; *Dialogues concerning Natural Religion*; *Enquiry X*.
- **Distinction:** God as support, as mechanism, and as casualty.
- **Criticism:** in Berkeley, God does matter's old job - which is the real question about the system.